

PAINFUL HOMECOMING

The biggest comeback in recent UFC history ended in heartbreak, raising fresh questions over **Conor McGregor's** future.

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UFC 329 was marketed around one storyline: Conor McGregor's long-awaited return after five years away from the Octagon.

While the card delivered several standout performances, McGregor's ill-fated comeback against Max Holloway ultimately overshadowed everything else.

The main event lasted just 69 seconds.

McGregor came out aggressively, attempting a flying kick before landing awkwardly and suffering a serious knee injury that forced the fight to be stopped.

It was a heartbreaking end to one of the most anticipated comebacks in UFC history, leaving fans with more frustration than closure.

The result raises significant questions about McGregor's future. Ring rust was always expected after a five-year lay-off, but another major injury has further complicated any roadmap back to contention.

At 38 years old, and having endured multiple career-altering injuries, McGregor now faces the

toughest battle of his career—not inside the cage, but in proving he can still compete at the elite level.

McGregor is set to undergo knee surgery for a suspected ACL injury.

"Five years off in this sport is rough. We're assuming a blown ACL. That's what I assumed when I saw it, and that's what the doctors think too," UFC CEO Dana White said after the main event.

For Max Holloway, the victory may have lacked the emphatic finish he envisioned, but it nevertheless strengthens his resume. A win over one of the sport's biggest stars further enhances his legacy, even if the circumstances denied fans a genuine five-round contest.

Away from the headline attraction, UFC 329 showcased the promotion's next wave of stars. Paddy Pimblett continued his rapid ascent with another impressive victory, further cementing his status as one of the UFC's biggest attractions outside its established champions.

Robert Whittaker enjoyed a successful light-heavyweight debut, while Brandon Royval and Olympic

Did you know?

Despite becoming the UFC's first simultaneous two-division champion, Conor McGregor never defended either of his titles. He won the featherweight belt by knocking out José Aldo and the lightweight title by defeating Eddie Alvarez, but was later stripped of both championships after remaining inactive and pursuing other opportunities.

wrestling gold medallist Gable Steveson also delivered performances that generated considerable buzz.

The event also highlighted the UFC's changing landscape. While McGregor remains the promotion's biggest commercial draw, UFC 329 demonstrated that it is actively building around emerging names capable of headlining major pay-per-view events. Pimblett's growing popularity and the continued rise of several contenders suggest the UFC's future is in capable hands.

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